



05/14/2026

Addendum No. 4

Solicitation Number: RFP 061726

Solicitation Name: Enterprise Artificial Intelligence: Platforms, Services, and Integrated Delivery

Consider the following Question(s) and Answer(s) to be part of the above-titled solicitation documents. The remainder of the documents remain unchanged.

Question 1:

Can a Lot 1 proposer include standardized enablement, adoption, training, governance, and deployment support services as complementary services packaged with an enterprise AI platform subscription, provided that the AI platform remains the proposer's primary deliverable and primary source of value?

Answer 1:

Refer to Section II.B. Primary Deliverable Determination and Lot 1: AI Products and Platforms.

In the competitive process, Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the content of the proposal. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine how to best satisfy all requirements of the questionnaire tables.

Question 2:

The RFP states that the proposer will be responsible for the development, deployment, operation, and maintenance of the solution. Could you please clarify whether this scope also includes knowledge transfer and/or transition activities to the client?

Answer 2:

Refer to Addendum 3, Answer 4.

Question 3:

Does the organization have a preferred cloud platform or hosting environment, or is the proposer expected to recommend the most suitable cloud solution as part of the proposal?

Answer 3:

Sourcewell is requesting proposals to meet the various needs of its 50,000+ Participating Entities as a whole, across the United States and Canada. In this competitive solicitation process, Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the contents of its proposal. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to articulate and propose the solutions that align with its business methods and satisfies the requirements of the RFP. A Participating Entities' unique needs will be determined if and when the Participating Entities choose to utilize a contract resulting from this solicitation.

Question 4:

Could you please outline the evaluation process for the proposals, including the anticipated timeline for commencement of evaluations?

Answer 4:

Refer to RFP, Section VI. Evaluation and Award, Subsection A.

Question 5:

With reference to Section H, Page 11, could you please clarify the proposer's expected role in marketing or promoting the Master Agreement award?

Answer 5:

Refer to RFP Section II. H. Marketing Plan, "Proposer's sales force will be the primary source of communication with Participating Entities. The Proposer's Marketing Plan should demonstrate Proposer's ability to deploy a sales force or dealer network to Participating Entities, as well as Proposer's sales and service capabilities. It is expected that Proposer will promote and market any master agreement award."

The Sourcewell Supplier Development team will also provide support and resources to expand and enhance awarded supplier marketing efforts. In the competitive process,

Sourcewell does not advise on the content of proposer marketing plans. Each proposal will be evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 6:

Can Sourcewell provide examples of the types of AI use cases participating agencies are most interested in (healthcare, education, public safety, operations, bare-metal etc.)?"

Answer 6:

Refer to Section II. B. Requested Equipment, Products, or Services for examples within each Lot, and Section VI. A. Responsiveness Criteria for a definition and examples of qualifying highly regulated industries.

Question 7:

Can Sourcewell confirm the required compliance frameworks for this contract (HIPAA, SOC 2, ISO 27001, CJIS, etc.) for vendors providing AI compute or hosting services?

Answer 7:

Refer to Answer 3.

Question 8:

Are there any data residency requirements for agencies using AI compute or hosting services under this contract?"

Answer 8:

Sourcewell is requesting proposals to meet the various needs of its 50,000+ Participating Entities as a whole, across the United States and Canada. In this competitive solicitation process, Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the contents of its proposal. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to articulate and propose the solutions that aligns with its business methods and satisfies the requirements of the RFP. A Participating Entities' unique needs will be determined if and when the Participating Entities choose to utilize a contract resulting from this solicitation.

Question 9:

Does Sourcewell have any minimum performance expectations for AI compute (e.g., memory bandwidth, GPU memory size, or throughput) that vendors should meet or exceed?" We utilize the Nvidia H200s for maximum compute.

Answer 9:

Refer to Answer 8.

Question 10:

Regarding potential evaluation points, Table headings for 7A and 7B read as follows:

- Table 7A: Depth and Breadth of Offered Solutions (200 Points, applies to Table 7A and 7B)
- Table 7B: Responsible AI & Governance (175 Points)

Evaluation scoring criteria lists:

- Responsible AI & Governance – 175 pts
- Depth and Breadth of Offered Solutions – 200 pts

Following the logic, are we correct in our analysis that this creates a possible 375 points for Tables 7A and 7B? Is Table 7B essentially evaluated under two categories?

Answer 10:

Refer to Amendment 2.

Question 11:

Historically, Sourcewell has specifically excluded products, solutions, and services available through currently active Master Agreements. With no exclusions identified in 061726, Enterprise AI: Platform, Services, and Integrated Delivery we respectfully submit the following questions:

- a) Will Sourcewell issue an Amendment to RFP 061726 to exclude existing contracts such as 121923 Technology Products and Services and 110724 AI Readiness, Implementation, and Support Services?
- b) If there is no Amendment detailing existing contract exclusion, how will Sourcewell address the addition of suppliers offering similar solutions to previously solicited, evaluated, and competitively awarded contracts?

Answer 11:

Sourcwell does not currently plan to issue an amendment or addendum to RFP 061726 regarding contract exclusions. While Sourcwell acknowledges there may be slight overlap with previously released RFPs, Sourcwell believes the AI engagement-focused response criteria and current lot structure included in this RFP provide sufficient guardrails to prevent the solicitation from overlapping too closely with existing contracts.

Question 12:

Will Sourcwell please delineate the primary differences between Enterprise AI Products, Services, and Solutions offered in the forthcoming 061726 contract against 121923 Technology Products and Services and 110724 AI Readiness, Implementation, and Support Services?

Answer 12:

Refer to Addendum 2, Answer 2.

Question 13:

Response Template, Table 4, Question 47. Does Sourcwell prefer that the example of how governmental and educational customers have successfully utilized e-Procurement or e-Commerce ordering processes be included in the response narrative or included as detailed attachment?

Answer 13:

It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine the information or documentation necessary to best demonstrate their ability to serve Sourcwell Participating Entities and satisfy all the requirements included in the questionnaire tables.

Question 14:

What is the minimum and maximum service providers that Sourcwell will select for each lot?

Answer 14:

Refer to the Evaluation and Award section of the RFP VI. It is the intent of Sourcwell to award one or more suppliers offering the best overall quality, selection of equipment, products, and services, and prices that meet the commonly requested specifications of

Sourcewell and its Participating Entities. The award(s) will be limited to the number of proposers that Sourcewell determines is necessary to meet the needs of its Participating Entities.

Question 15:

For Lot 2, may proposers submit multiple pricing models, such as time-and-materials rates, fixed-fee service packages, managed services tiers, and optional transaction-based pricing?

Answer 15:

All proposed pricing must be submitted using *one or more* of the pricing structures, as appropriate to the proposer's Primary Lot and commercial model, listed in RFP Section III. A. 1.

Question 16:

For professional services pricing, does Sourcewell prefer hourly rates, daily rates, or will either be acceptable if not-to-exceed rates are clearly provided by labor category?

Answer 16:

It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine and propose the pricing approach that aligns with their business methods and satisfies all the requirements of RFP Section III – Pricing and Delivery Schedules. Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Also refer to Answer 15.

Question 17:

The RFP requires a Pricing Narrative explaining cost scaling, price-change triggers, and total cost of ownership. Is Sourcewell expecting this narrative as a separate uploaded document, a portal response, or part of the pricing attachment?

Answer 17:

A specific format is not required for submission, but Excel is preferred. Each supplier will propose pricing in the format that makes sense for their industry. Each proposer, in its discretion, will determine and articulate the pricing approach that aligns with its business methods and satisfies all the requirements of the III. Pricing section of the RFP. Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 18:

For third-party costs such as cloud hosting, model/API consumption, software licensing, OCR tools, or other pass-through costs, should proposers include not-to-exceed rates where available or identify them as excluded/pass-through costs to be priced at the Participating Entity task-order level?

Answer 18:

Refer to Answers 15 and 16 above.

Question 19:

Can Sourcwell clarify whether the administrative fee should be embedded into proposed pricing or treated separately in the proposer's internal commercial model?

Answer 19:

Refer to RFP III. B. and Master Agreement Article II. G. Administrative Fees. The administrative fee is paid by the awarded supplier to Sourcwell and is not to be separately assessed to a participating entity.

Question 20:

Under "Depth and Breadth of Offered Solutions," should Lot 2 proposers emphasize the breadth of professional services only, or should they also describe related tools, frameworks, accelerators, and partner technologies used to deliver those services?

Answer 20:

In the competitive process, Sourcwell will not advise a proposer on the content of the proposal. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine how to best satisfy all requirements of the questionnaire tables.

Question 21:

Under “Ability to Sell and Deliver Solutions,” what evidence is most useful: national delivery footprint, sales coverage, customer support model, delivery staffing, implementation methodology, or public-sector contract adoption strategy?

Answer 21:

Refer to Addendum 1, Answer 1

Question 22:

Under “Responsible AI & Governance,” is Sourcewell looking primarily for proposer internal AI governance policies, client-facing governance services, implementation controls, or all of these?

Answer 22:

It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine the information or documentation necessary to best demonstrate their ability to serve Sourcewell Participating Entities and satisfy all the requirements included in the questionnaire tables. Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the contents of its proposal.

Question 23:

If a Lot 2 proposer uses third-party AI platforms, cloud services, LLMs, OCR tools, automation tools, or model APIs as part of delivering professional services, should those be described as enabling tools under Lot 2 rather than as separate Lot 1 products?

Answer 23:

Per RFP Section II. D. Single Primary Lot, “Sourcewell prefers suppliers that provide a sole source of responsibility for the equipment, products, and services provided under a resulting master agreement. If proposer includes the equipment, products, and services of its subsidiary entities, the proposer must also identify all subsidiaries included in its proposal. If proposer requires the use of distributors, dealers, resellers, or subcontractors to provide the equipment, products, or services, the proposal must address how the equipment, products or services will be provided to Participating Entities, and describe the network of distributors, dealers, resellers, and/or subcontractors that will be available to serve Participating Entities under a resulting master agreement.”

Primary Lot selection is the proposer’s determination and reflects how they primarily create value for Participating Entities.

Question 24:

If a proposer provides both AI professional services and access to third-party technology components, but does not commercialize its own AI platform as the primary offering, is Lot 2 still the appropriate Lot?

Answer 24:

Refer to Answer 23.

Question 25:

The RFP states that proposers must demonstrate experience delivering AI solutions in a highly regulated industry at a scale appropriate to the selected Lot. For Lot 2, what type of evidence will Sourcewell consider sufficient to demonstrate this requirement?

Answer 25:

Refer to Addendum 1, Answer 1.

Question 26:

For Lot 2, how does Sourcewell define “scale appropriate to the selected Lot”? Is Sourcewell looking for number of engagements, size of client, dollar value, number of users supported, number of workflows implemented, geographic reach, or a combination?

Answer 26:

Responsiveness Criteria thresholds and requirements are listed in the RFP Specifications Questionnaire under the section titled Responsiveness Criteria. The Questionnaire can be found in the [Sourcewell Procurement Portal](#).

Question 27:

Will Sourcewell allow proposers to include confidential client examples in summarized or anonymized form if the work is covered by confidentiality obligations?

Answer 27:

Refer to RFP Section VI. E. Disposition of Proposals, which states, “Proposers are explicitly cautioned not to submit any data that they consider to be confidential,

proprietary, or trade secret, as such data will not be treated as confidential and will be subject to public disclosure in accordance with Minnesota law.”

Question 28:

Under Section II.D “Single Primary Lot,” the RFP states a preference for a single source of responsibility and allows the use of subcontractors, distributors, and related entities where appropriately described. However, the RFP does not explicitly address whether Joint Venture (JV), consortium, or team-based prime submissions (i.e., two or more entities jointly submitting as a single prime contractor) are permitted. Please clarify whether Joint Venture or consortium bids are allowed under this solicitation.

Answer 28:

A proposer may submit only one proposal. If related, affiliated, or subsidiary entities elect to submit separate proposals, rather than a single parent-entity proposal, each such proposal must be prepared independently and without cooperation, collaboration, or collusion. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine the information or documentation necessary to best demonstrate their ability to serve Sourcewell Participating Entities and satisfy all the requirements of the RFP.

Question 29:

After watching the video and hearing the references to 'highly regulated industries' I revisited the RFP and noted in a number of places that 'highly regulated industries' is mentioned. On the first web page reference is made to 'governmental, higher education, K-12 education, nonprofit, tribal government, and other public agencies located in the United States and Canada' - I am having trouble reconciling highly regulated industries with some of the types of organisations mentioned, which makes responding confusing (when I think of highly regulated I think of Banking, Air Transportation, Nuclear Energy, Medical and other regulated professions). Is experience in 'highly regulated industries' a requirement?

Answer 29:

Refer to RFP Section VI. A. Responsiveness Criteria, as well as the thresholds and requirements listed in the RFP Questionnaire under the section titled, Responsiveness Criteria. Both areas provide a definition of highly regulated industries and examples of qualifying highly regulated industries.

Question 30:

In the list of organisations - 'governmental, higher education, K-12 education, nonprofit, tribal government, and other public agencies located in the United States and Canada' - which of those do you consider regulated?

Answer 30:

Refer to RFP Section VI. A. Responsiveness Criteria, as well as the thresholds and requirements listed in the RFP Questionnaire under the section titled, Responsiveness Criteria. Both areas provide a definition of highly regulated industries and examples of qualifying highly regulated industries.

Question 31:

RFP Section II.B Primary Delivery Determination #3, pg. 5
Relating to Primary Lot selection as stated in RFP II.B Primary Delivery Determination #3, if a Bidder wishes to be considered for Lots 1 and 2, the direction is that the bidder should select Lot 3, correct?

Answer 31:

Sourcewell will not pre-qualify any products or services. It is left to the discretion of each Proposer to determine if its products or services meet the scope of RFP II. B. Requested Equipment, Products, or Services. Only those products within the scope of the RFP will be included in any contract awarded by Sourcewell as a result of the solicitation.

Question 32:

RFP Section II.B Primary Delivery Determination #3, pg. 5
If a bidder is bidding Primary Lot 3, should the Bidder provide responses to Demonstrated Experience requirements for Lots 1, 2, and 3; or just Lot 3?

Answer 32:

For the Responsiveness Criteria Demonstrated Experience tables (pages 2–5 of the RFP Questionnaire), proposers must identify the single, Primary Lot for which they are submitting a response and complete only the corresponding Demonstrated Experience table.

Question 33:

For purposes of the Lot 1 responsiveness criteria regarding “production deployments,” would Sourcewell consider multiple operational deployments of the same AI platform across distinct enterprise customer environments or facilities as separate deployments, provided each deployment: supports ongoing operational use, includes defined users/workflows and measurable outputs, and operates within separate production environments?

Answer 33:

In the competitive process, Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the content of the proposal. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine how to best satisfy all requirements of the questionnaire tables.

Question 34:

As presented on the Pre Proposal Conference, Sourcewell described a process to evaluate and award Lots consecutively, starting with Lot 1 and moving on to Lot 2 and finally Lot 3. Adding to the degree of complexity, Section I. Additional Consideration, Question 5 of the RFP reads that Sourcewell may need to organize responses into subcategories and awards may be based on those subcategories which may create an even more extended timeline per Lot.

With an unknown, and likely large, number of responses submitted this strategy, while thorough, creates the potential for an extended timeline between submission and potential award. Upon solicitation close, and based on the number of responses received, is Sourcewell considering alternate evaluation and award practices (i.e., concurrent evaluation and award across Lots 1, 2, and 3) to minimize time from submission to award and maximize potential impact to Sourcewell Members?

Answer 34:

The duration of the evaluation process will depend on the number and complexity of responses received. Following the solicitation close, Sourcewell may reevaluate the evaluation and award approach, as needed, provided any adjustments remain consistent with the process and requirements outlined in the RFP.

End of Addendum

Acknowledgement of this Addendum to RFP 061726, posted to the Sourcewell Procurement Portal on 05/14/2026, is required at the time of proposal submittal.

PREVIEW

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